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Employer guide to Egypt's new Labour Law No. 14 of 2025

What changed for employers, plus employee benefits in Egypt for 2026

Labour Law No. 14 of 2025 was issued on 3 May 2025, took effect on 1 September 2025 and repealed Law No. 12 of 2003. The new specialised labour courts started on 1 October 2025. This guide sums up what an employer needs to know, together with the statutory and market-standard employee benefits in Egypt.

Contracts and records

- Employment contracts are written in Arabic in four copies; a non-Egyptian employee may also have a copy in their own language. Paper or electronic signature is allowed.
- Employers file a statement of employees and salaries with the Ministry of Labour and update it every January.
- Each employee's file, paper or electronic, is kept for five years after employment ends.
- The law recognises remote work, part-time work, flexible hours and job sharing.
- Non-Egyptians may only be employed with a work licence from the competent ministry.

Probation, termination and resignation

- Probation is capped at three months, once per employee with the same employer.
- Notice on an indefinite contract is three months, regardless of length of service.
- Resignations are ratified by the competent administrative authority and the employer responds within 10 days. Pre-signed, undated resignations are void.
- Fixed-term contract ended by the employer: one month's salary per year of service.
- Disciplinary dismissal requires a ruling from the labour court.

Working hours and overtime

- 8 hours a day and 48 hours a week, with at most 12 hours of presence a day.
- Overtime now needs notification to the Ministry within 7 days instead of prior approval.
- Overtime pay: wage + 35% by day and + 70% at night.

Pay and the annual raise

- Annual periodic raise of at least 3% of the insured wage (Article 12); waivers need National Wages Council approval.
- Private-sector minimum wage: EGP 7,000 a month since 1 March 2025 (latest published National Wages Council decision).
- Training and Qualification Fund: 0.25% of the minimum insured wage per employee, minimum EGP 10 and maximum EGP 30, replacing 1% of net profits.
- Salary payment can be evidenced by bank transfer.

Workplace protection and penalties

- Harassment, bullying and verbal, physical or psychological violence are criminalised, offline or online.
- Fines range from EGP 1,000 to EGP 100,000, and the responsible manager is liable alongside the employer.

Employee benefits in Egypt, 2026

Benefit	Detail	Type
Social insurance (Law 148/2019)	Employer 18.75% and employee 11% of the insured wage. Insured wage from January 2026: EGP 2,700 to 16,700 a month.	Statutory
Annual leave	15 days in year one, 21 days from year two, 30 days after 10 years or at age 50, and 45 days for employees with disabilities.	Statutory
Sick leave	Paid through the social insurance system, on a certificate from the competent medical authority.	Statutory
Maternity leave	Four months paid, at least 45 days of it after birth, up to three times in service, with no minimum service.	Statutory
Childcare leave	Up to two years unpaid, three times, after one year of service, in establishments with 50+ employees.	Statutory
Paternity leave	One paid day on the day of birth, up to three times, not deducted from annual leave.	Statutory
Annual raise	At least 3% of the insured wage every year.	Statutory

Benefit	Detail	Type
Private medical insurance	Common practice: about EGP 15,000 to 45,000 per employee a year for individual cover.	Market practice
Year-end bonus	Not mandatory. Typically half a month to one month of base pay; 1 to 3 months for strong performers or sectors.	Market practice
Flexible work	Recognised in law; typically 1 to 3 days a week from home for office roles.	Market practice
Learning budget	About EGP 5,000 to 25,000 per employee a year.	Market practice

What to do now

- ✓ Review contracts: Arabic, four copies, three-month notice.
- ✓ Update the leave policy (15/21/30/45 days), maternity and paternity leave.
- ✓ Build the 3% annual raise into your payroll cycle.
- ✓ Prepare the annual employee statement and keep files for five years.
- ✓ Align resignation and disciplinary procedures with administrative ratification and the labour courts.

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Sources

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